

DELHI | Digital Doomsday

The end of the Internet seems to be near. Or at least that's what the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) is saying, warning computer users of a shortage of new Internet Protocol (IP) addresses. Over 85 per cent of the IP addresses on the Net have been taken. The rest will be exhausted by early 2011. In May 2010, the Internet Assigned Numbers Authority, the body that allots global IP addresses, will stop allotting new ones. So in another two years, Internet Service Providers will run out too. IP numbers are based on the Internet Protocol Version 4 (IPv4) platform which has a capacity of four billion addresses. The solution is IPv6, which can introduce another 16 billion, is available but hasn't been implemented widely, says P.K. Saji, senior vice-president at Sify Technologies. *by Nandini Vaish*

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BANGALORE | Royal Challenge

After much hullabaloo over the acquisition of his sword by Vijay Mallya in 2004, Tipu Sultan is in the news again. Historians have discovered the clothes Tipu Sultan wore on the day he was killed in Srirangapatnam. Considering that his sword (one of the 12 he used), was sold for Rs 1.5 crore at an international auction, researchers have put the value on the historic Tipu robe at a whopping Rs 30 crore. The robes that have been discovered are also believed to contain bloodstains from the Tiger of Mysore's wounds in the battle. Now in the possession of the Tipu Sultan Wakf Board, the clothes and battle armour will be shown at a public exhibition later this month. *by Nirmala Ravindran*

MUMBAI | Poll Alliance

Couples wanting to tie the knot in Maharashtra may first have to confess whether they have voted in the previous elections. Perturbed by the poor show by Mumbaiers on polling day, the Maharashtra Pradesh Congress Committee (MPCC) has presented a list of 36 to-dos to spread awareness on the importance of voting to the Election Commission. "If we link this education with major events in a person's life, such as marriage, we can inculcate a greater sense of responsibility towards voting," says Sanjay Dutt, general secretary, MPCC.

BANGALORE | Bungalow Bungle

Recession may have the world reeling but it looks like it hasn't hit ministers in Karnataka yet. An RTI application reveals that Karnataka ministers have been busy spending Rs 3 crore on refurbishing their official bungalows. The biggest slice of that taxpayer's pie belongs to Chief Minister B. S. Yeddyurappa—the Public Works Department (PWD) spent Rs 89 lakh on redoing his house. Not all ministers are pleased at the expense though. Law and Parliamentary Affairs Minister Suresh Kumar shot off a letter to the chief secretary asking for details of the Rs 16 lakh spent on his official residence. PWD officials, of course, have the bills to justify the expenditure. *by Stephen David*

by Aditi Pai

A GOVERNMENT
BUNGALOW IN BANGALORE